

MR. T. F., STOCK BROKER: USED VEHICLE-PRONE DEALER LOYALIST

Mr. T. F. is a stock broker and a millionaire who enjoys purchasing late-model, used, luxury automobiles. After purchasing several models from the same dealer, Mr. T. F. had an idea: He would make a personal sales call to the owner of the dealership. Mr. T. F. first reminded the owner that he had purchased three cars from him in the past five years and had referred several of his clients to the dealer. Mr. T. F. then asked the dealer if he would reciprocate by giving him some of his investment business. The dealer's response was very frank. He told Mr. T. F. that he sold vehicles to dozens of stock brokers and that he could not do business with all of them.

Mr. T. F. understood the dealer's position. So he made a counterproposal. He asked if the dealer would be so kind as to give him the names of his top five suppliers:

Assume that you were asked to nominate the suppliers of the year in this state. Who would be on the top of your list? Who put the new roof on this place? Can I mention that you suggested I call him?

The dealer did refer several of his key suppliers to Mr. T. F. Mr. T. F. still buys his vehicles from this dealer and makes referrals on his behalf. In turn, the dealer refers business to Mr. T. F.

AUTHOR TOM STANLEY SELLS A CAR

Just before Christmas, I placed a classified ad in the local newspaper to sell my family's Acura Legend. Prior to doing so, I called our dealer. He advised me about the upper-limit price I could anticipate receiving for the car, and that was the price that we advertised. I have always meticulously maintained our motor vehicles. Our Legend had nearly every conceivable option, including the so-called Gold Package. The car was always garaged. Our Acura dealer did all the prescribed